

PURPOSE: To place the couches back in Hooper's Reading Room

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**BE IT RESOLVED BY THE MISSISSIPPI SCHOOL FOR MATHEMATICS AND
SCIENCE**

SECTION ONE (REASONING):

The Reading Room in Hooper is a lively place. Students use that space to study, converse, and socialize in between or after classes, and it is a beloved part of our facilities here at MSMS.

However, at the beginning of this year, many of the seniors noticed a stark change: the couches were removed and replaced with a row of rolling chairs. While there hasn't been a major uproar or negative reaction to this, various students have wondered where the couches went, why they were taken away, and if they'll be back.

Though not confirmed, the suspected reasons for the removal are that one, students napping on the couches cast a "bad image" on the school to prospective students, and two, parents touring and college representatives coming to speak to the students. I, and other students I have consulted, have issues with this logic.

First, when touring, potential students and parents are mainly focused on the academic life and facilities MSMS has to offer. Their attention is not fixed on the students in the Reading Room; they usually stride past and move on to gazing inside the classrooms or labs going on. If we were to humor the notion that sleeping students would deter people from coming to MSMS, it can be negated simply by looking at everything else our school has to offer. Our facilities are impressive and advanced enough to outweigh a negative opinion caused by an insignificant glance at a sleeping student.

On college representatives, they are typically, if not always, stationed in Hooper's lobby. This means that they won't get the opportunity to see or form an opinion on napping students.

MSMS's image won't suffer at all by bringing back the couches. I've consulted students—all seniors because they had the couches last year—and everyone I asked was in support of this as a means to socialize, destress, and overall boost wellness and morale during the academic day.

SECTION TWO (RESPONSES): I asked four students two questions: “Do you think we should bring the couches in the Reading Room back? Why or why not?”

Response 1 (Anonymous):

Yes, of course. During the stressful day, we all need a place to relax, and it was great, comfortable seating. Whenever this is the only place you have to go [in between classes], it’s like a nice living room for everyone to destress and socialize.

Response 2 (Anonymous):

Absolutely. Sometimes, a quick power nap is what you need to get ready for your next class. It would help student morale a lot.

Response 3 (Anonymous):

Yes. I believe the couch should be put back in the reading room because it made for a more relaxing environment in the Reading Room, especially after a very stressful test where students could come in and enjoy each other’s company instead of it being a sole place to do work, as it seems to be right now.

Response 4 (Anonymous):

Yes. These new chairs are almost broken, and the couches were durable and comfortable, too.

SECTION THREE (PROPOSED ACTION):

The couches that used to be in the Reading Room are stored somewhere, as they were only removed when the school year started. The current conference table in the room will stay, but the couch that sat underneath the whiteboard on the rightmost side of the room (looking in from the doorway) will be put back.